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Scramble, resistance and a new non-alignment strategy

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In what way is imperialism today different from the imperialisms of the past? And what strategies are capable of undermining it?

The most basic elements of contemporary imperialism have been analysed extensively. They consist in the formation of a collective imperialism, an unprecedented event, the ongoing internationalisation of production, the re-financialisation of monopoly capital, and continuous military aggression, long after the end of the Cold War.

The economic changes underway have now sapped collective imperialism of its economic vitality and its domestic social peace, obliging it to escalate its military project externally and its class offensive internally. The concrete result today is a new wave of natural resource grabs and new military interventions in the peripheries, accompanied by the demise of social pacts in the centres of the system.

It is clear that the great systemic rivalry of the Cold War had no real winners among the superpowers. The Soviet Union may have been the first to succumb, but disaster is now looming in the centres as well. The only concrete advance of the last half-century has been decolonisation and the emergence of the South. This marked the beginning of the end of the system born in 1492.

The emergence of the South has produced a new set of challenges. During the Cold War, the Bandung movement outlined a coherent set of objectives, comprising total decolonisation, economic development, and 'positive non-alignment'. The latter meant, specifically, non-participation in the military blocs